Where You Are: Safety and Support, the Middle of Step Two

What this part of the road is for and what comes after it, with all nine steps shown.

With a date set for your husband's move, it can feel as though the whole plan has to be finished this week. It doesn't. The work comes in an order, and you're in the early part of it.

Below is the whole road, your place on it, and what follows.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Discovery Summary

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Assessment Summary

You are here. You're on the middle topic of this step, Safety & Support: who will be there for your husband in the next arrangement, and which safety worries go to the care team. You finish it with the concerns and the open hours written down, a name beside each, and the unanswered safety questions handed to a professional instead of being treated as settled.

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Immediate Action Roadmap

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Care Options Comparison and Decision Record

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Proposal, Good Day Plan, and Monitoring Plan

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition Preparation Pack and Confirmed Handoff Log

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team Plan and Care-Plan Alignment Record

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Care Review Dashboard and Concern/Change Logs

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support

You finish with: Family Care Management Playbook and Handoff/Support Plan

What this step produces

A written picture of the support around your husband's next arrangement: what you've noticed, when help is planned and by whom, the hours with no name beside them, what the professionals have already told you, and who is following up on each open question. It is the family's notes, in order. It isn't a safety assessment, and finishing it doesn't clear the arrangement.

Medicare's discharge checklist calls the patient and the caregiver important members of the planning team, and says to talk to the doctor and the staff, such as a discharge planner, social worker or nurse, about the items on it. The page you build here is what you bring to that conversation. [1]

What happens next

The topic before this one, Health & Function, looked at what your husband can do day to day. This one adds who is there while he does it. One more topic finishes the step: Lifestyle & Preferences, his own account of how he wants to live.

His preferences have a place of their own for a reason. AARP's planning guide says every family caregiving plan must center on the wishes of the person receiving the care. [2]

After that, the step called Define Needs turns the whole picture into a statement of what his care has to cover.

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: mapping who is there and when, noticing, writing down, and saying honestly what each of you can do.
- Your husband: his own account of where he wants help and what worries him.
- The discharge team and his clinicians (doctor, nurse, pharmacist, therapist, discharge planner, social worker): the safety questions, and what anything means for his care.
- With your care consultant: a review of falls, supervision, medication management and his surroundings, a look for gaps in caregiver coverage, and a record of recurring health concerns for the care team, not care instructions.

What this page doesn't promise

A timetable, anyone's availability, or how the move turns out. Every family goes through these steps at its own pace.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits and what follows it. The care interview is how you finish it: it asks about your husband's situation area by area, safety and support included, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The line about the planning team is from Medicare's discharge checklist, and the line about centering a plan on the person's wishes is from AARP's planning guide.

1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, Your Discharge Planning Checklist (CMS Product No. 11376)
2. AARP, Prepare to Care: A Planning Guide for Families